

1. Communicators & Creators

Fundamental orientation:	I turn ideas into messages, stories, and experiences that engage an audience.
Signature skills:	Close reading; clear and persuasive writing; editing and revision; rhetorical analysis; audience awareness; argument construction; storytelling; interpretation; synthesis; translating complex ideas for different audiences; oral presentation; media and visual literacy; creative ideation; content strategy.

Career pathways and representative roles

Career pathway	Representative roles
Writing & Editorial	Writer; Staff Writer; Copywriter; Editor; Copy Editor; Managing Editor; Editorial Director; Technical Writer; Medical Writer; Speechwriter; Ghostwriter
Communications & PR	Communications Coordinator; Communications Specialist; Communications Manager; Communications Director; PR Specialist; Publicist; Media Relations Specialist; Public Affairs Specialist; Press Secretary
Content & Digital Media	Content Writer; Content Specialist; Content Strategist; Content Manager; Social Media Specialist; Social Media Manager; Digital Content Manager; Web Content Manager; Podcast Producer
Marketing & Brand	Marketing Coordinator; Marketing Specialist; Marketing Communications Manager; Brand Strategist; Brand Manager; Campaign Manager; Creative Strategist
Design & Creative	Graphic Designer; Visual Designer; UX Writer; Content Designer; Creative Producer; Art Director; Creative Director; Illustrator
Film, Audio & Media Production	Photographer; Videographer; Filmmaker; Video Editor; Producer; Multimedia Producer; Audio Producer; Podcast Producer; Documentary Producer
Interpretation & Public Humanities	Interpretive Planner; Exhibit Developer; Museum Interpretation Specialist; Public Historian; Humanities Program Producer; Cultural Content Specialist

2. Researchers & Educators

Fundamental orientation	I discover, interpret, organize, and share knowledge.
Signature skills	Research question development; primary- and secondary-source research; source evaluation; information literacy; close reading; archival and library research; contextualization; qualitative inquiry; interviewing; synthesis across sources; citation and documentation; interpretation; teaching and discussion facilitation; knowledge translation.

Career pathways and representative roles

Career pathway	Representative roles
Academic Research	Research Assistant; Research Associate; Research Fellow; Researcher; Historian; Scholar; Postdoctoral Fellow; Research Professor; Research Director
Applied Research & Insights	UX Researcher; Market Researcher; Qualitative Researcher; Audience Researcher; Consumer Insights Researcher; Research Consultant; Insights Manager
Policy & Social Research	Policy Researcher; Social Science Researcher; Research Analyst; Survey Researcher; Think Tank Researcher; Public Policy Researcher
Teaching & Higher Education	Teacher; Lecturer; Instructor; Professor; Teaching Professor; Academic Program Director; Department Chair
Learning & Development	Instructional Designer; Curriculum Developer; Learning Specialist; Corporate Trainer; Learning & Development Specialist; Learning Experience Designer; Training Manager
Libraries, Archives & Knowledge	Librarian; Archivist; Digital Archivist; Records Specialist; Knowledge Manager; Information Specialist; Research Librarian
Museums & Cultural Research	Curatorial Assistant; Curator; Collections Researcher; Museum Researcher; Public Historian; Museum Educator; Education Program Manager
Institutional & Prospect Research	Institutional Research Analyst; Prospect Researcher; Advancement Researcher; Research Services Manager; Institutional Research Director

3. Analysts & Strategists

Fundamental orientation	I make sense of complexity, identify patterns, and help organizations decide what to do.
Signature skills	Critical analysis; close reading of complex material; comparison and pattern recognition; synthesis across multiple sources; contextual reasoning; evidence-based argumentation; identifying assumptions; framing problems; interpreting ambiguity; evaluating competing explanations; ethical and historical perspective; clear recommendation writing; strategic thinking.

Career pathways and representative roles

Career pathway	Representative roles
Business Analysis	Business Analyst; Senior Business Analyst; Business Intelligence Analyst; Operations Analyst; Management Analyst
Strategy	Strategy Analyst; Strategy Associate; Strategic Planning Manager; Corporate Strategist; Strategy Director; Chief Strategy Officer
Consulting	Analyst; Associate Consultant; Management Consultant; Strategy Consultant; Organizational Consultant; Principal Consultant
Policy Analysis	Policy Analyst; Legislative Analyst; Regulatory Analyst; Public Policy Analyst; Senior Policy Analyst
Program Evaluation	Program Analyst; Program Evaluator; Evaluation Specialist; Monitoring & Evaluation Specialist; Impact Evaluation Manager
Insights & Intelligence	Insights Analyst; Competitive Intelligence Analyst; Intelligence Analyst; Market Intelligence Analyst; Research Strategist
Organizational Strategy	Organizational Development Specialist; Change Management Consultant; Organizational Effectiveness Manager; Workforce Strategy Analyst
Institutional Strategy	Institutional Research Analyst; Planning Analyst; Higher Education Strategy Analyst; Institutional Effectiveness Director

4. Advocates & Advisors

Fundamental orientation	I help people and organizations navigate decisions, institutions, rules, and competing interests.
Signature skills	Argumentation; persuasive writing and speaking; textual and policy interpretation; evidence evaluation; ethical reasoning; perspective-taking; debate and discussion; research; stakeholder communication; negotiation; mediation; judgment; explaining complex rules and ideas clearly; constructing and assessing competing claims.

Career pathways and representative roles

Career pathway	Representative roles
Law & Legal Services	Paralegal; Legal Assistant; Legal Analyst; Attorney; Counsel; General Counsel
Policy & Legislative Affairs	Legislative Assistant; Legislative Analyst; Legislative Director; Policy Advisor; Senior Policy Advisor; Policy Director
Government & Public Affairs	Government Affairs Associate; Government Relations Manager; Public Affairs Manager; Government Affairs Director
Advocacy	Advocacy Coordinator; Advocate; Advocacy Manager; Campaign Manager; Advocacy Director; Grassroots Organizer
Compliance & Ethics	Compliance Specialist; Compliance Analyst; Compliance Manager; Ethics Officer; Regulatory Affairs Specialist
Advising	Academic Advisor; Career Advisor; Student Success Advisor; Admissions Counselor; Financial Aid Advisor; International Student Advisor
Mediation & Conflict Resolution	Mediator; Conflict Resolution Specialist; Employee Relations Specialist; Labor Relations Specialist; Ombuds
Community & Constituent Affairs	Constituent Services Representative; Community Advocate; Community Affairs Specialist; Community Relations Manager

5. Helpers & Service Professionals

Fundamental orientation	I work directly with people to understand their needs, solve problems, and improve their well-being or experience.
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Signature skills	Active listening; empathy and perspective-taking; cross-cultural interpretation; careful observation; contextual understanding; ethical reasoning; discussion and facilitation; interpersonal communication; reflective practice; qualitative assessment; case analysis; clear writing and documentation; interpreting lived experience and social context.
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Career pathways and representative roles

Career pathway	Representative roles
Human Services	Human Services Specialist; Case Worker; Case Manager; Family Services Specialist; Social Services Coordinator
Social Work & Counseling	Social Worker; Counselor; Therapist; Behavioral Health Specialist; Mental Health Counselor
Healthcare Support & Advocacy	Patient Advocate; Patient Navigator; Community Health Worker; Patient Experience Specialist; Care Coordinator
Student Support	Student Services Specialist; Student Success Coordinator; Residence Life Coordinator; Student Affairs Specialist; Student Support Manager
Customer Success	Customer Success Specialist; Customer Success Manager; Client Success Manager; Customer Experience Manager
Client Services	Client Services Coordinator; Client Services Specialist; Client Relationship Manager; Client Services Director
Hospitality & Guest Experience	Guest Services Representative; Guest Experience Manager; Hospitality Manager; Visitor Services Manager
Community Services	Community Services Coordinator; Outreach Worker; Community Support Specialist; Constituent Services Specialist

6. Connectors & Relationship Builders

Fundamental orientation	I create opportunities by building trust, cultivating relationships, and connecting people and organizations.
Signature skills	Persuasive communication; audience awareness; active listening; storytelling; relationship building; cultural fluency; perspective-taking; stakeholder research; synthesizing interests and viewpoints; negotiation; presentation; written outreach; interviewing and conversation; translating ideas into compelling cases for action or support.

Career pathways and representative roles

Career pathway	Representative roles
Sales	Sales Representative; Sales Development Representative; Account Executive; Sales Manager; Sales Director
Business Development	Business Development Associate; Business Development Manager; Business Development Director; Growth Manager
Partnerships	Partnerships Coordinator; Partnerships Manager; Strategic Partnerships Manager; Director of Partnerships
Fundraising & Development	Development Associate; Development Officer; Major Gifts Officer; Annual Giving Manager; Development Director; Chief Development Officer
Foundation & Corporate Relations	Foundation Relations Officer; Corporate Relations Manager; Institutional Giving Manager; Corporate Partnerships Director
Alumni & Donor Relations	Alumni Relations Coordinator; Alumni Relations Director; Donor Relations Manager; Stewardship Officer
Recruiting & Talent Acquisition	Recruiting Coordinator; Recruiter; Executive Recruiter; Talent Acquisition Specialist; Talent Acquisition Manager
Community Engagement	Community Engagement Coordinator; Outreach Manager; Community Partnerships Manager; External Relations Director
Membership & Associations	Membership Coordinator; Membership Manager; Member Engagement Director; Association Relations Manager

7. Leaders & Organizers

Fundamental orientation

I bring people, processes, and resources together to turn goals into results.

Signature skills

Clear written and oral communication; organizing complex information; synthesis; facilitation and discussion leadership; collaborative problem-solving; perspective-taking; ethical reasoning; decision framing; research and preparation; giving and incorporating feedback; project coordination; prioritization; documentation; leading work through ambiguity.

Career pathways and representative roles

Career pathway	Representative roles
Administration & Coordination	Administrative Assistant; Administrative Coordinator; Executive Assistant; Program Assistant; Office Coordinator; Office Manager
Project Management	Project Coordinator; Project Manager; Senior Project Manager; Project Director; Portfolio Manager
Program Management	Program Coordinator; Program Manager; Senior Program Manager; Program Director
Operations	Operations Coordinator; Operations Specialist; Operations Manager; Director of Operations; VP Operations; COO
Events & Production	Event Coordinator; Conference Coordinator; Event Manager; Conference Manager; Event Director
People Management	Team Lead; Supervisor; Department Manager; Regional Manager; General Manager
Organizational Leadership	Director; Executive Director; Managing Director; Vice President; President; CEO
Executive & Strategic Coordination	Executive Coordinator; Chief of Staff; Deputy Chief of Staff; Director of Administration
Academic Administration	Academic Coordinator; Department Administrator; Program Director; Department Chair; Dean; Provost

8. Builders & Technologists

Fundamental orientation	I build, implement, and improve tools, products, technologies, and systems.
Signature skills	Digital literacy; research and information gathering; user-centered interpretation; qualitative inquiry; clear writing and documentation; translating needs into requirements; systems and contextual thinking; information architecture; iterative problem-solving; content design; ethical analysis of technology; communicating between technical and nontechnical audiences.

Career pathways and representative roles

Career pathway	Representative roles
Software & Web	Web Developer; Software Developer; Front-End Developer; Application Developer; Software Engineer
Product	Product Coordinator; Associate Product Manager; Product Manager; Senior Product Manager; Product Director
User Experience	UX Designer; Interaction Designer; Information Architect; UX Strategist; Content Designer
IT & Systems	IT Specialist; Systems Administrator; Systems Analyst; Information Systems Manager; IT Director
Business Systems	Business Systems Analyst; CRM Administrator; Salesforce Administrator; Enterprise Systems Specialist
Implementation & Solutions	Implementation Specialist; Implementation Manager; Solutions Consultant; Solutions Architect; Technical Consultant
Digital Humanities & Scholarship	Digital Humanities Specialist; Digital Scholarship Librarian; Digital Projects Manager; Digital Collections Specialist
Knowledge & Information Systems	Knowledge Management Specialist; Information Architect; Knowledge Systems Manager; Information Manager
Emerging Technology & AI	AI Product Specialist; AI Content Specialist; AI Implementation Consultant; Responsible AI Specialist; AI Program Manager

9. Financial & Resource Stewards

Fundamental orientation	I manage money, resources, risk, and accountability so organizations can operate sustainably.
Signature skills	Analytical reading; attention to detail; evidence evaluation; research; interpreting policies, rules, and documentation; clear explanatory writing; quantitative literacy; contextual judgment; ethical reasoning; risk awareness; synthesis; communicating technical or financial information to non-specialists; budgeting, forecasting, compliance, and resource stewardship.

Career pathways and representative roles

Career pathway	Representative roles
Accounting	Accounting Assistant; Staff Accountant; Senior Accountant; Accounting Manager; Controller
Financial Analysis	Financial Analyst; Senior Financial Analyst; Finance Manager; Finance Director
Budgeting & Planning	Budget Analyst; Budget Manager; Financial Planning Analyst; Director of Budget and Planning
Grants & Sponsored Programs	Grants Assistant; Grants Administrator; Grants Manager; Sponsored Programs Officer; Research Administrator
Contracts & Procurement	Contracts Administrator; Contract Specialist; Procurement Specialist; Procurement Manager
Audit & Compliance	Auditor; Internal Auditor; Compliance Analyst; Financial Compliance Manager; Risk Analyst
Investment & Financial Services	Investment Analyst; Portfolio Analyst; Credit Analyst; Banking Associate; Investment Manager
Revenue & Business Finance	Revenue Analyst; Pricing Analyst; Commercial Finance Analyst; Business Finance Manager
Financial Leadership	Controller; Treasurer; VP Finance; Chief Financial Officer

Sector and Work Context

Sector and work context are separate classification dimensions. They should not compete with skill archetypes: a role can use the same core skills in many different industries and at different levels of responsibility.

Sector

Sector	Typical settings
Business & Professional Services	Consulting firms, agencies, corporations, professional associations, B2B services
Technology	Software, digital products, IT, platforms, AI, technology services
Healthcare & Human Services	Hospitals, health systems, clinics, behavioral health, social services, community health
Education & Academia	K-12, colleges and universities, research centers, education providers, edtech
Government & Public Policy	Federal, state, local government, legislative offices, public agencies, think tanks
Nonprofit & Philanthropy	Nonprofits, foundations, advocacy organizations, associations, NGOs
Arts, Culture & Media	Museums, libraries, archives, publishers, journalism, film, performing arts, cultural organizations
Finance & Financial Services	Banks, investment firms, insurance, accounting, fintech, financial institutions
Law & Legal Services	Law firms, legal departments, courts, legal aid, regulatory and compliance organizations
Retail, Hospitality & Tourism	Retailers, hotels, restaurants, travel, tourism, visitor attractions, customer-facing services

Work Context

Work context	Definition
Individual Contributor	Primarily responsible for one’s own specialized work rather than formally managing a team.
Manager	Leads people, projects, programs, or functions and is accountable for team-level outcomes.
Executive	Sets organizational or enterprise-level direction and carries broad decision-making responsibility.
Founder / Entrepreneur	Creates and leads a new venture, organization, practice, or business.

Work context	Definition
Freelancer / Independent Practitioner	Works independently for clients or maintains a self-directed professional practice.

Example Classifications

Job title	Primary archetype	Career pathway	Sector	Work context
UX Researcher	Researchers & Educators	Applied Research & Insights	Technology	Individual Contributor
Museum Executive Director	Leaders & Organizers	Organizational Leadership	Arts, Culture & Media	Executive
Independent Grant Writer	Communicators & Creators	Writing & Editorial	Nonprofit & Philanthropy	Freelancer / Independent Practitioner
Healthcare Policy Analyst	Analysts & Strategists	Policy Analysis	Healthcare & Human Services / Government & Public Policy	Individual Contributor
Development Director	Connectors & Relationship Builders	Fundraising & Development	Nonprofit & Philanthropy	Manager

Classification Guidance

Use the archetype to describe the work, not the industry. A healthcare communications director belongs primarily under Communicators & Creators; healthcare is the sector. A nonprofit program manager belongs under Leaders & Organizers; nonprofit is the sector.

Allow a secondary archetype when the role is genuinely hybrid. A museum curator may be primarily a Researcher & Educator and secondarily a Communicator & Creator. A nonprofit executive director may be primarily a Leader & Organizer and secondarily a Connector & Relationship Builder.

Do not force every title into a single meaning. The same title can represent different work in different organizations. Classify based on the role's actual responsibilities and dominant skills, not the title alone.

Keep pathways more stable than job titles. Job titles change rapidly. Career pathways such as Fundraising & Development, Applied Research & Insights, or Project Management provide a more durable organizing structure.

Treat sectors as filters, not destinations. The framework is most useful when people can see that a skill archetype travels across sectors. Researchers, communicators, analysts, relationship builders, and organizers are needed in nearly every part of the economy.

Complete classification model

Job Title → Primary Archetype → Secondary Archetype (optional) → Career Pathway → Fundamental Orientation → Signature Skills → Sector(s) → Work Context